

Tablets under ₹10,000

Marvell India plans to bring out 10-inch Android 2.2 tablets priced close to the ₹10,000 mark whereas 7-inch ones should come around ₹6,000

X-Pire date for your photos

X-Pire is a browser add-on that allows you to set an expiry date for images, after which they will not be viewable

Bazaar

Samsung ST80

Digital camera with integrated social-networking

Nimish Sawant

If there was one thing missing in today's compact digital camera's, then it has to be social network connectivity. This is one edge, connected smartphones have over digital cameras. But Samsung has closed that gap with its latest offering - the ST80, which comes with an internal WiFi antenna which allows you to transfer photographs over the air.

The ST80 comes in a cozy form factor with rounded edges all around. The zoom lens occupies around half the front portion real estate. On the back you have a 3-inch wide touch screen surrounded by a textured bezel. Build quality

is quite tacky with an overall plastic body.

Macro shots were disappointing as the focussing was not upto the mark. We noticed a lot of noise in most of macro shots. Daylight shots also left a lot to be desired. ISO performance is good upto ISO400, after which images are heavily noisy. Low light photography is not this camera's strong point either. It can record upto 720p video, but the auto focussing while shooting and zooming in and out in live video mode was really bad. The front portion of the camera tends to heat up after prolonged use.

Wireless performance was what impressed us. It



was fun transferring images and videos to our social networking platforms without having to go through the whole ritual of transferring images to the desktop and then uploading them.

At ₹14,999 the camera is adequately priced for the WiFi connectivity feature. It's ideal for those who want to instantly share photos. Definitely not recommended for the discerning photographer.

Specifications

Sensor : 14.2MP; ISO range : 100 - 3200; WiFi connectivity; Video resolution : 720p; Media : MicroSD card; Internal Memory : 22MB; Image Stabilization present

Contact

Samsung India Electronics Pvt. Ltd

Phone: +91 12 4488 1234

Email: sharad.a@samsung.com

Web site: www.samsung.com/in

Price: ₹14,999

6.0/10

Features.....	8.0
Performance.....	5.5
Build Quality.....	5.0
Value for money.....	6.5

Specifications

Socket: AM3; Cache: L1 512, L2 2GB, L3 6GB; Stock CPU Clock: 3.6 Ghz

Contact

AMD India

Email: fusion.india@amd.com

Web site: www.amd.com

Price: ₹10,000 approx (\$200)

7.0/10

Features.....	6.5
Performance.....	7.0
Build Quality.....	NA
Value for money.....	7.0

AMD Phenom II X4 975 BE

Fastest clocked quad from the AMD stable

Siddharth Parwatya

The start of the new year brings a powerful processor from AMD with a strong lineage - the Phenom II family. Clocked at 3.6 GHz, this makes it the highest clocked, top-of-the line quad core CPU from AMD. Being a Black Edition piece, it belongs to the enthusiast grade, easily overclockable range of processors that feature an unlocked multiplier.

We ran the CPU through the whole gamut of our test process benchmarks. The processor is surprisingly adept at Floating Point stress benchmarks,

inching ahead of the top of the line Intel quad core - the Core i7 875K. It returned a score of 11.341 sec on Wprime (32million) as against a 13.543 sec by the Intel CPU. However, it fell short when it came to rendering benchmarks - the i7 875K was 30% faster at Cinebench CPU rendering on all cores. In terms of real world benchmarks, as expected, it was slightly ahead of other AMD predecessors such as the 955 and 965 BE.

AMD has always been the leader when it comes to pro-

viding value based solutions. We compared it to the sub ₹10,000 Sandybridge i5 2500K which is the next iteration in the i5 series. (We didn't have the i5 750). The 975 certainly didn't outperform, but at least held its own, which is good considering Sandybridge is a new architecture. We also compared it to the six core X61075T. With that particular CPU it's worth noting that if you're not an overclocker and ready to plonk in about ₹500 more, you get two additional cores (good for future proofing).

